SYNTHETIC EXAMPLE POLICY -- NOT A REAL INSURER DOCUMENT
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Plan Name: BCBS PPO Plus 2025
Effective Date: January 1, 2025
Document Version: v1.0
Applies To: In-network and out-of-network benefits unless otherwise stated.

1 Overview of Covered Benefits

This Policy provides coverage for Medically Necessary services that are not otherwise excluded. Covered Benefits include, but are not limited to:

- Physician office visits and specialist consultations
- Laboratory and diagnostic testing
- Specialty and biologic drug therapy (Formulary-based, subject to Prior Authorization)
- Emergency services

2 Member Eligibility and Plan Status

Benefits are payable only if the member is enrolled and the Plan is active on the date of service. If the member's Plan is inactive at the time services are rendered, the claim will be denied. Denial reason: "Plan inactive at time of service."

3 Prior Authorization (Pre-Approval)

3.1 Services Requiring Prior Authorization

The following services require Prior Authorization:

- Specialty drugs listed as "PA Required" on the Formulary, including biologic injections for severe asthma
- Elective inpatient admissions
- CT and MRI scans (except emergency)
- Durable medical equipment (DME) exceeding $500

3.2 Documentation Required

Prior Authorization requests must include: (1) ordering provider's clinical note, (2) relevant diagnosis code(s), (3) prior treatment history (if applicable), and (4) expected service date and location. If documentation is missing, the request will be pended until complete information is received -- no approval or denial can be issued until it is.

4 Medical Necessity Standard

A service is considered Medically Necessary if it is consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice, clinically appropriate in type, frequency, and setting, not primarily for convenience of the member or provider, and the most cost-effective option among clinically comparable alternatives.

5 Coverage for Specialty and Biologic Drug Therapy

5.1 Biologic Injection Coverage (Asthma)

A biologic injection for asthma is covered when all of the following are met:

- Diagnosis of severe persistent asthma (e.g., J45.40 or related codes); and
- Documented inadequate control on standard inhaled corticosteroid therapy; and
- Prior Authorization has been approved, supported by a clinical note.

Prior Authorization requests missing the ordering provider's clinical note cannot be evaluated for medical necessity and must be pended for documentation.

5.2 Preventive and Screening Services

Routine screening laboratory panels (e.g., a lipid panel performed without symptoms or a qualifying diagnosis) are classified as preventive screening and are excluded from standard coverage under this plan. Denials for services classified as preventive screening may only be overturned on appeal if new clinical documentation is submitted

establishing a qualifying diagnosis or symptomatic indication; an appeal letter alone, without new clinical documentation, does not meet this bar and the original denial should be upheld.

6 Exclusions

The Plan does not cover: cosmetic or reconstructive procedures not required by trauma or congenital anomaly; services deemed not Medically Necessary; experimental or investigational treatments; services for which required Prior Authorization was not obtained; routine preventive screening as described in 5.2; duplicate claims for the same service date and provider unless corrected and resubmitted.

7 Claims Processing Rules

7.1 Duplicate Claims

A claim is considered duplicate if Member ID, Provider NPI, Date of service, CPT / procedure code, and billed amount all match. Duplicate claims are denied with reason: "Duplicate claim submission."

7.2 Coding Consistency

Claims are routed for coding review if the diagnosis and procedure codes are clinically inconsistent based on standard coding guidelines. Such claims must not be approved until coding review is complete.

8 Appeals

Members and providers have the right to appeal a denial within 180 days. Appeals must include a written appeal request, the denial letter or claim reference number, and any new clinical documentation relevant to the denial reason. Appeals without new or relevant clinical documentation may be upheld.

9 Contact Information

For questions about benefits, Prior Authorization, or claim status, contact BCBS Member Support at 1-800-555-0133 or via the Member Portal.